

Forward passes by hand

Project: Image-pattern Network Investigation

1. Prepare the purpose, prerequisites and materials

Teach the learning cycle

Primary target: Record scores and activations in dependency order

Session · Sequence and minutes · Resources

Session: Session 1 · Understand · 45 min

Sequence and minutes: 0–7: recall and prerequisite; 7–15: inspect the concrete case and predict; 15–30: teacher models the worked trace; 30–40: learners explain a step using the text and visual; 40–45: check the core idea.

Resources: Sections 1–6; record the brief recall in the workbook.

Session: Session 2 · Practise · 45 min

Sequence and minutes: 0–5: retrieve the procedure; 5–15: W2 completion practice; 15–23: explain and check with a partner; 23–30: each learner answers the misconception check; 30–40: targeted reteaching or a harder variation; 40–45: prepare the investigation.

Resources: Sections 7–10; use the matching workbook W2 and misconception check.

Session: Session 3 · Investigate and transfer · 45 min

Sequence and minutes: 0–5: retrieve the decision rule; 5–20: investigate or trace; 20–30: start the independent case; 30–38: connect the project; 38–43: act on feedback; 43–45: plan the return check.

Resources: Sections 9 and 11–14. Give extra time to finish the full task set; use Section 15 when the week includes a coding lab.

This is a starting allocation of 135 minutes, not a validated duration. Preserve all named topics. Schedule extra time for connected examples, the full investigation, independent cases and project building. Repeated copies of a case share one recorded attempt; they are not new evidence.

Retrieval answer guidance

Composing layers

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Composing layers. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Trace how one layer supplies the next layer inputs

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: Scores are -2 and 2; activations are 0 and 2; $y = 0 - 2 + 1 = -1$.

Bias terms and decision boundaries

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Bias terms and decision boundaries. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Calculate a weighted score with a bias term

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: Weighted sum $10 - 4 = 6$; bias -3; score 3; prediction 1. Add the bias once after summing.

Use two 45-minute sessions to build a habit of recording intermediate values. Students should identify the first disagreement, then propagate the correction. Do not award full credit for a correct final value supported by an incorrect trace.

Outcomes

Record scores and activations in dependency order

Locate the first incorrect value in a forward trace

Separate a final output from evidence of model accuracy

Preparation

Printed lesson and workbook; paper and pencil

Calculator and optional local Python 3 editor; no packages or AI accounts needed

Use the fictional examples supplied; prepare the fresh retry before class

Prerequisite answer

It receives the ordered hidden activation vector, rather than the original input or the scores before activation.

End goal for the pictorial case

By the end, I can explain forward passes by hand using a traced example and a stated limitation.

This added worked case illustrates the week's main idea. Retain all original and connected topics;

schedule its practice within the teaching cycle.

2. Explain and model the mechanism

Use a new one-input network with two hidden units. Its scores are $z_1 = 2x - 1$ and $z_2 = -x + 2$. Apply ReLU to obtain h_1 and h_2 . The output is $y = h_1 - 2h_2 + 1$. Parameters stay fixed while the input changes. The input x is an abstract number; these are arithmetic examples, not measurements of children.

A forward pass evaluates this network in dependency order. Compute both scores from x , then both activations, then the output contributions h_1 and $-2h_2$, and finally add bias 1. A trace table makes an omitted bias or a sign error easier to locate than a final answer alone.

At $x = 1$ the output is exactly zero. If we later declare class 1 for $y \geq 0$, equality belongs to class 1. Applying ReLU in the hidden layer does not make the final output nonnegative.

For $x = 0$, the first score is -1 , which ReLU changes to 0. The second score is 2, which ReLU leaves at 2. Therefore $y = 0 - 4 + 1 = -3$. Negative output is allowed because this output layer uses identity.

This optional Python uses only numeric inputs. Compare every returned component against the table. The same code being run twice is a repeatability check; comparing it with a separately calculated expectation is a stronger check of correctness.

Term · Meaning

Term: Trace

Meaning: A record of intermediate values in a computation

Term: Preactivation

Meaning: A weighted score before an activation function

Term: Dependency

Meaning: An earlier value needed to compute a later value

Term: Regression check

Meaning: A retained test rerun after a change to detect a new error

Correct a trace from the earliest error

Trace stage at x is 0 · Expected value · Submitted value

Trace stage at x is 0: Scores

Expected value: [-1, 2]

Submitted value: [-1, 2]

Trace stage at x is 0: ReLU activations

Expected value: [0, 2]

Submitted value: [-1, 2]

Trace stage at x is 0: Output

Expected value: -3

Submitted value: -4

The columns compare expected and submitted traces. The first disagreement is the activation of -1, not the final addition. Recompute all dependent values after repairing it.

Guided: $x = 2$ gives $z = [3, 0]$, $h = [3, 0]$, $y = 4$; the zero score remains zero. Exit: no; final agreement can hide compensating errors. Retain correct intermediate expectations and varied regression cases, not only the single final output.

Model the reasoning aloud

Use the complete worked example below before asking learners to complete W2. Reveal a small part, invite a prediction, then explain the deciding step. These teacher notes contain solutions; do not reveal the independent case answer during modelling.

Correct a trace from the earliest error

Trace stage at x is 0 · Expected value · Submitted value

Trace stage at x is 0: Scores

Expected value: [-1, 2]

Submitted value: [-1, 2]

Trace stage at x is 0: ReLU activations

Expected value: [0, 2]

Submitted value: [-1, 2]

Trace stage at x is 0: Output

Expected value: -3

Submitted value: -4

The columns compare expected and submitted traces. The first disagreement is the activation of -1, not the final addition. Recompute all dependent values after repairing it.

Trace x = 2, recording both scores, both activations and y. What happens to the second unit at its zero-score boundary?

Thinking move · Teacher prompt

Thinking move: Plan

Teacher prompt: What is given? What is the question? Which procedure fits these facts?

Thinking move: Do

Teacher prompt: Point to each input and intermediate step in the worked trace. Name the rule that allows the next step.

Thinking move: Check

Teacher prompt: Does the output answer the question? Which assumption or limitation prevents a larger claim?

Use the diagram and verbal explanation together. Ask learners to match a sentence to a specific visual step; do not assign learners fixed visual or auditory learning styles.

A pictorial worked case: Forward passes by hand

Audit a forward pass by writing every value at its correct stage.

The facts we will use

Toy scalar network $z=2x-1$, $h=\text{ReLU}(z)$, $y=-h+4$. Trace $x=0$ and $x=2$.

All inputs and outcomes in this worked example are invented classroom data; no real model run is claimed.

AI ACADEMY / AI-5/6

Forward passes by hand

Start with the supplied facts

Follow each arrow. Ask which fact allows the next step.



1. Preactivation

At $x=0$, $z=-1$; at $x=2$, $z=3$.



2. Activation

At $x=0$, $h=0$; at $x=2$, $h=3$.



3. Output

Outputs are 4 and 1 respectively.

CHANGE ONE THING

A submitted $x = 0$ trace uses $h=-1$ and $y = 5$.

Explain the changed result using the matching lesson.

Read the picture one step at a time

Step · What happens and why

Step: 1. Preactivation

What happens and why: At $x=0$, $z=-1$; at $x=2$, $z=3$.

Step: 2. Activation

What happens and why: At $x=0$, $h=0$; at $x=2$, $h=3$.

Step: 3. Output

What happens and why: Outputs are 4 and 1 respectively.

Match each pictured step to the supplied facts. This is a worked teaching case, not an independent assessment.

Why this result follows

A forward pass applies a fixed network to an input; it does not update weights. Keep the preactivation z , activated value h and final output y in separate trace columns. For zero, ReLU changes minus one to zero. Using the earlier minus one in the output layer is the first error, even if later arithmetic follows that mistaken value correctly.

What this example does not establish

A correct forward trace verifies this declared computation; it does not show that the parameter choices solve a useful task.

Change one thing in the pictured case

Change: A submitted $x = 0$ trace uses $h=-1$ and $y = 5$.

Prediction: Its first error is retaining the negative value after ReLU; correct $h = 0$ gives $y = 4$.

Reason: $\text{ReLU}(-1)=0$, so the output must use 0, not the earlier preactivation.

Ask while showing the picture

Cover the result. Ask learners to name the inputs and predict the next step. Uncover one step, connect the icon to the actual procedure, and explain its evidence. Then change the supplied condition and compare. The picture is a representation; it does not document execution of a real AI model.

3. Demonstrate and guide practice

Time or stage · Teacher action

Time or stage: Session 1 start to 7 minutes

Teacher action: Retrieve the distinction between scores, hidden activations and output inputs.

Time or stage: 7 to 18 minutes

Teacher action: Trace $x = 0$ on the board. Label every column and identify the output bias.

Time or stage: 18 to 32 minutes

Teacher action: Complete W1 and compare the $x = 1$ and $x = 3$ worked rows. Discuss negative final outputs.

Time or stage: 32 to 45 minutes

Teacher action: Run or trace Python; complete the guided $x = 2$ case and W2.

Time or stage: Session 2 start to 8 minutes

Teacher action: Reconstruct a trace from memory, then check its dependencies against the formula.

Time or stage: 8 to 20 minutes

Teacher action: Complete W3 and discuss which cases detect missing activation and which detect order errors.

Time or stage: 20 to 35 minutes

Teacher action: Collect W4 independently, including the first erroneous stage and corrected descendants.

Time or stage: 35 to 45 minutes

Teacher action: Use W5 and the exit question, then offer the fresh retry after feedback.

Use the worked example in Sections 3 and 6. Collect a prediction before revealing its result; ask the learner to point to each intermediate fact.

Provide blank trace columns and allow a calculator for signed arithmetic. Extension: show that for $0.5 \leq x \leq 2$ the lesson output is $4x - 4$; verify both endpoints without applying that expression outside its stated interval.

Reduce help deliberately

Completion task: At $x = 3$ a trace gives $z = [5, -1]$, $h = [5, 0]$ and $y = 5$. Identify the first incorrect stage and repair it.

Teacher check: Teacher explanation: Scores and activations are correct. The output omitted bias 1; y should be 6.

Start by identifying the given inputs together. Leave the intermediate steps blank. If needed, model one step, then withdraw that help on the next step. Move to a full trace only when the partial trace is understood. For partners, alternate explainer and checker; collect a response from every learner before discussion.

Individual reasoning check

Use the worked case for Forward passes by hand. Proposed explanation: “ReLU means the output cannot be negative”. Decide whether this explanation is supported. Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Expected correction: Only the hidden scores receive ReLU here. The output formula can be negative.

Collect explanations, not only yes/no votes. If a misunderstanding is common, re-model the relevant step for the class. If it affects a few learners, give a short targeted group explanation while others solve a more demanding variation.

Pictorial practice question

Why should feedback identify h before correcting only y ? Point to the relevant step in the picture, then write the changed result and the rule or evidence that supports it.

Reasoned teacher answer

The incorrect output follows from the first unsupported activation step. Repairing h teaches the mechanism and prevents repeating the same error elsewhere. Changed-case check: Its first error is retaining the negative value after ReLU; correct $h = 0$ gives $y = 4$. $\text{ReLU}(-1)=0$, so the output must use 0, not the earlier preactivation.

Changed-case reasoning: Its first error is retaining the negative value after ReLU; correct $h = 0$ gives $y = 4$. $\text{ReLU}(-1)=0$, so the output must use 0, not the earlier preactivation.

Collect each learner’s explanation before discussion. Use the first missing connection between input, deciding step and result to choose support. This question is worked-case practice, not fresh mastery evidence.

4. Run the investigation and diagnose misconceptions

ReLU means the output cannot be negative: Only the hidden scores receive ReLU here. The output formula can be negative.

Fix just the final number: Repair the earliest incorrect operation and recompute every dependent value.

One passing case proves the network: Cases with equal activations or positive scores can hide specific defects.

Use Section 9 for the evidence ledger. Add a boundary or missing-input case and record the expected response before checking. More successful repeats of one case do not establish wider coverage.

Match the support to the first error

What the response shows · Next teaching action

What the response shows: Missing or misread facts

Next teaching action: Read the case aloud, mark supplied versus unknown facts, and let the learner restate it.

What the response shows: Wrong procedure

Next teaching action: Return to the deciding step in the worked case. Contrast it with the proposed incorrect explanation.

What the response shows: Arithmetic or implementation error

Next teaching action: Trace intermediate values or lines; preserve the first mismatch and retry that step.

What the response shows: Correct result without a reason

Next teaching action: Ask for a trace and a changed case before marking independent understanding.

What the response shows: An unsupported wider claim

Next teaching action: Ask which supplied evidence supports the claim and which further observation would be needed.

Offer an oral explanation, drawing, enlarged visual or fewer examples when that removes a reading/writing barrier. Keep the same reasoning goal. Stretch secure learners by changing a boundary or assumption and asking them to defend the effect, not simply by assigning more of the same questions.

5. Assess and explain the answers

Guided and exit questions

Guided: $x = 2$ gives $z = [3, 0]$, $h = [3, 0]$, $y = 4$; the zero score remains zero. Exit: no; final agreement can hide compensating errors. Retain correct intermediate expectations and varied regression cases, not only the single final output.

W1 Complete a fresh row

Trace $x = -1$ through the lesson network. Record z , h and y .

Teacher explanation: $z = [-3, 3]$, $h = [0, 3]$, $y = -5$.

W2 Locate a bias omission

At $x = 3$ a trace gives $z = [5, -1]$, $h = [5, 0]$ and $y = 5$. Identify the first incorrect stage and repair it.

Teacher explanation: Scores and activations are correct. The output omitted bias 1; y should be 6.

W3 Check both boundaries

Trace $x = 0.5$ and $x = 2$. Which hidden score is zero in each case?

Teacher explanation: At 0.5, $z = [0, 1.5]$, $h = [0, 1.5]$, $y = -2$. At 2, $z = [3, 0]$, $h = [3, 0]$, $y = 4$. Zero maps to zero under ReLU.

W4 Audit a different network independently

Use $z_1 = x + 1$, $z_2 = 2 - 2x$, $h = \text{ReLU}(z)$ component by component, and $y = 2h_1 + h_2 - 3$. Trace $x = 0$ and $x = 2$. A submitted $x = 2$ trace uses $h = [3, -2]$ and $y = 1$. Find its first error and correct all later values.

Teacher explanation: At 0: $z = [1, 2]$, $h = [1, 2]$, $y = 1$. At 2: $z = [3, -2]$, $h = [3, 0]$, $y = 3$. The first submitted error is $h_2 = -2$ rather than 0; the corrected output is 3.

W5 Limit a passing test

Explain why testing only $x = 1$ in the lesson model may miss a hidden-order swap.

Teacher explanation: Both hidden values equal 1, so exchanging them changes nothing. Use unequal hidden values, such as $x = 0$, and compare intermediate values as well as y .

Independent assessment and fresh retry

Assess W4 for both full traces and the activation error. Fresh retry: $h = \text{ReLU}(x - 2)$, $y = -3h + 2$. For $x = 1$ and $x = 4$, preactivations are -1 and 2, activations 0 and 2, outputs 2 and -4. A submitted $x = 1$ activation -1 is the first error, even if later arithmetic compensates.

Assess independent transfer

Selected case: Use $z_1 = x + 1$, $z_2 = 2 - 2x$, $h = \text{ReLU}(z)$ component by component, and $y = 2h_1 + h_2 - 3$. Trace $x = 0$ and $x = 2$. A submitted $x = 2$ trace uses $h = [3, -2]$ and $y = 1$. Find its first error and correct all later values.

Selected case answer

Teacher explanation: At 0: $z = [1, 2]$, $h = [1, 2]$, $y = 1$. At 2: $z = [3, -2]$, $h = [3, 0]$, $y = 3$. The first submitted error is $h_2 = -2$ rather than 0; the corrected output is 3.

Dimension · Evidence required

Dimension: Explanation

Evidence required: Names the applicable idea or procedure and ties it to the supplied facts.

Dimension: Trace and result

Evidence required: Preserves the given inputs and shows the relevant intermediate steps; distinguishes a prediction from an observed execution.

Dimension: Limits

Evidence required: States the assumptions, missing evidence or conditions under which the result would change.

Record each dimension as not yet, with support, or independent. Accept a valid alternative procedure with a defensible trace. Do not penalise an honestly recorded model failure if the learner correctly explains its evidence and limits.

Feedback that the learner uses

Name the earliest unsupported step and give one action to repair it. Have the learner make that repair now and explain why. Then assess the relevant skill on a fresh, fully specified case. Confirm it was not previously practised with feedback; solve and check the new case before assigning it. A follow-up design prompt is a starting brief, not automatically an equivalent test.

6. Connect the project, support and next lesson

Add a labelled forward passes by hand evidence sheet to Image-pattern Network Investigation. Show how you can record scores and activations in dependency order. Use the supplied fictional case and keep its inputs, intermediate steps, calculation or prediction, and limitation. Connect this record to last week's record; a matching answer without a trace is insufficient.

Provide blank trace columns and allow a calculator for signed arithmetic. Extension: show that for $0.5 \leq x \leq 2$ the lesson output is $4x - 4$; verify both endpoints without applying that expression outside its stated interval.

Week 7 names architectural choices and counts dense-layer parameters.

Retain the project ledger and assess a changed case after support. Check the relevant prerequisite before carrying this component forward.

Plan the delayed return

Suggested return points in this level: ai-5/7, ai-5/9, ai-5/12. Use actual classroom dates, adjusting for holidays and gaps. One, three and six teaching weeks are scheduling choices, not a claimed optimal

spacing.

At a delayed check, ask for the idea from memory and a changed application. Compare with the earlier independent response and record support used. For a new level, revisit the previous capstone before checking the new prerequisites.

Record · Teacher evidence

Record: Learner code and date

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Concept and case used; prior exposure

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Explanation / trace / limits

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Support and first repair

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Changed case and delayed outcome

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Next teaching action

Teacher evidence: _____

Use the evidence to choose reteaching or the next step. A completed page, confidence rating or attractive project does not by itself demonstrate understanding.

Project evidence from this case

For your Image-pattern Network Investigation, save the input, procedure, observed result and limitation of this check. Label this worked example as practice; use a different, previously unreviewed case when checking independent understanding.